Checking-Account Buffer

Use a protected checking floor for ordinary timing gaps and small overages.

Chosen checking floor: $_____ Current cushion: $_____

Amount still needed: $_____ Affordable payday addition: $_____

Timing gap / routine overage	Amount ($)	Refill date

Before new spending: checking balance - pending transactions - assigned bills - protected floor.

Keep the jobs separate:

Checking buffer: ordinary timing gaps. One-month-ahead reserve: next month's bills, held in designated savings until needed.

Sinking fund: anticipated irregular costs. Emergency savings: major unexpected expenses or income disruption.

Example amounts are illustrations. Set a target that fits your expenses and income stability.